

WEALTH DYNAMICS

The US has led the number of ultra-rich. India has grown the fastest in the past five years

	UHNWI* population 2021	UHNWI population 2026	UHNWI population 2031 (forecast)	Change 2021-26	Change 2026-31 (forecast)
World	5,51,435	7,13,626	9,48,241	29.4%	32.9%
US	1,84,436	2,51,352	3,87,422	36.3%	54.1%
China	98,924	1,21,677	1,44,602	23%	18.8%
India	12,161	19,877	25,217	63.4%	26.9%
BY REGION					
North America	1,95,089	2,64,272	4,04,218	35.5%	53%
Asia-Pacific	1,75,776	2,19,310	2,72,530	24.8%	24.3%
Europe	1,46,525	1,83,953	2,15,195	25.5%	17%

NOTE *UHNWI IS ULTRA HIGH NET WORTH INDIVIDUAL; UHNWIs WORTH $30M+
SOURCE KNIGHT FRANK, THE WEALTH REPORT 2026

a simple trade. The ultra-wealthy have money, but no time. "What they have the least of is time," says Bhangay. So they pay someone to absorb the friction.

India is producing such people quickly. According to The Wealth Report 2026 by global real estate consultancy Knight Frank, the number of ultra-high-net-worth individuals (UHNWIs) in India rose 63% from just over 12,000 to nearly 20,000 between 2021 and 2026. Globally, the number of UHNWIs—people worth more than $30 million—grew from 551,435 to 713,626 over the period. The US accounted for 41% of the increase.

The growing UHNWI population offers concierge firms a larger pool of potential customers. But wealth alone does not explain the appeal of these services. Visa's Affluent Economy 2025–26 white paper points to a difference in booking behaviour. While emerging affluent people depend heavily on online travel agencies, the ultra-elite—those spending more than ₹6 lakh a month on discretionary purchases—are more likely to plan travel through a concierge, an agent or a private club, says the report.

AI changes the economics of that delegation. Once connected to the right systems, it can compare options, make recommendations, complete bookings, and manage amendments with less additional human labour. That, in turn, can lower the cost of serving each member.